

UNCLE EDWARD LUNT

By Sylvia Lunt Heywood
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I'm very thankful that I had the opportunity to know Uncle Edward. He was a very special, kind man. Always happy and cheerful.

It was at his and Aunt Letties home that my father spent his last days on this earth. How kind they were to take him into their home and help care for him when he was so ill and required care day and night as he suffered so much following cancer surgery. This was not an easy thing to do when they had a large family of their own to care for. As a small child of 5, I remember that after we arrived from Mexico and went to their home to see our father. I was very impressed with their beautiful, well kept and comfortable home on their farm. It was full of love! Aunt Lettie and Uncle Edward were always so loving and kind to all of us.

I remember the visits Uncle Edward made to our homes in Mexico. When we were living in Juarez, I especially remember the time he was there for a visit. One evening he had been out visiting other friends in town and when he returned to our home some of us were out in the street playing. My younger brother, Gary wanted to go for a little ride as the pickup Uncle Edward was driving slowed down to a stop. Gary ran to jump on the side of it to ride the last few yards but he slipped and fell underneath the truck. As a result, he had a badly broken leg up in the thigh area. Uncle Edward surely felt bad about this accident and did all he could to see that Gary received medical care and was well taken care of. Gary had to stay in bed for a long time with his leg in a cast from foot to his hip and suspended straight up in the air with a weight and pulley.

Uncle Edward loved horses, cattle and ranching. He wanted to move back to Mexico and so purchased a ranch there, first in the mountains and then one in the Dublin area with Brother Memmott who was married to Aunt Letties sister, Nilus. Very often Uncle Edward would visit down there and come in to see us and talk to Uncle Loren about the ranch. At times he'd bring samples of tall grass he had pulled up at his ranch to show us how good the feed was there. As the time passed, he sold his interest in the ranch and moved to Mesa to work in the Temple.

When I got married, I spent the night before my marriage visiting with Uncle Edward and Aunt Lettie at their home in Mesa. Uncle Heaton and Aunt Chloe were also at their home that night since they had come from Duncan to attend my wedding. My first time to attend a Temple session was very special because Uncle Edward and Aunt Lettie took the parts of Adam and Eve. I will never forget that.

After my husband was released from the service, we moved from El Paso to Phoenix and on the way over we stopped to visit Uncle Edward in Duncan. At that time he was ill with leukemia and so he and Aunt Lettie were living in Duncan with their daughter Almeda who was helping care for him. Although he was very ill, he was his usual cheerful self and was joking and making the best of things. That is the last time I saw him alive. When he passed away a few months later I rode to Duncan with Mac Hanchett and Eugene Romney to attend his funeral.

Uncle Edward was a very humble man and yet he had a keen sense of humor. He always cheered everyone up and looked at the bright side of life. His daughters are beautiful and his sons are handsome. He and Aunt Lettie had a wonderful family that they can be so proud of.